

# Microsoft Office

## *Beginner to Expert*

*Covering Word · Excel · PowerPoint*

| Application          | Primary Use                 | Skill Level Covered |
|----------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------|
| Microsoft Word       | Documents, Reports, Letters | Beginner → Expert   |
| Microsoft Excel      | Spreadsheets, Data, Charts  | Beginner → Expert   |
| Microsoft PowerPoint | Presentations, Slides       | Beginner → Expert   |

# Part 1: Microsoft Office Overview

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## What is Microsoft Office?

Microsoft Office is the world's most widely used suite of productivity applications. Originally released in 1990, it has grown into a powerful ecosystem of tools that help individuals and organizations create documents, analyse data, build presentations, manage email, and much more.

Today, Office is available both as a traditional desktop installation (Microsoft 365) and as cloud-based web apps accessible through any browser. Whether you are a student, a business professional, or a creative, Microsoft Office has a tool designed for you.

## The Core Applications

| App                  | Icon Colour | Core Purpose                              | Common File Type |
|----------------------|-------------|-------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Microsoft Word       | Dark Blue   | Word processing — letters, reports, books | .docx            |
| Microsoft Excel      | Dark Green  | Spreadsheets — data, budgets, charts      | .xlsx            |
| Microsoft PowerPoint | Orange-Red  | Presentations — slides, pitches, training | .pptx            |
| Microsoft Outlook    | Light Blue  | Email, calendar, contacts                 | .pst / .ost      |
| Microsoft OneNote    | Purple      | Digital notebooks and note-taking         | .one             |
| Microsoft Teams      | Purple      | Collaboration, chat, video calls          | Cloud            |

## The Microsoft 365 Interface

All Office apps share a common design language. Understanding one app makes it easier to learn the others.

### The Ribbon

The Ribbon is the toolbar at the top of every Office application. It is organised into tabs (e.g. Home, Insert, Review) and each tab contains groups of related commands.

- Home tab — The most-used everyday commands (font, copy, paste)
- Insert tab — Add tables, images, charts, headers and footers
- Review tab — Spelling check, track changes, comments

- View tab — Change how the document is displayed on screen

 **Tip:** You can press the Alt key on your keyboard to reveal keyboard shortcuts for every ribbon button. Each button will show a letter or number you can press to activate it without the mouse.

## Microsoft 365 vs. Older Versions

| Feature       | Office 2019                   | Microsoft 365                  |
|---------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Updates       | One-time purchase, no updates | Continuous updates included    |
| Cloud Storage | Not included                  | 1 TB OneDrive included         |
| Collaboration | Limited                       | Real-time co-authoring         |
| AI Features   | Minimal                       | Copilot AI assistant included  |
| Cost          | One-time fee                  | Monthly or annual subscription |

## General Tips for All Office Apps

- Save frequently — Use Ctrl+S (Windows) or Cmd+S (Mac) to save your work
- Undo mistakes — Press Ctrl+Z to undo and Ctrl+Y to redo
- Use AutoSave — In Microsoft 365, enable AutoSave so files are saved to the cloud automatically
- Customise the Quick Access Toolbar — Add your most-used buttons to the bar above the Ribbon
- Use the Tell Me / Search bar — Type what you want to do and Office will find the feature for you

# Part 2: Microsoft Word

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## Introduction to Microsoft Word

Microsoft Word is the most popular word-processing application in the world. It lets you create, format, and share text-based documents — from a simple shopping list to a 500-page book. Word is used by students for essays, by businesses for reports and contracts, and by professionals for letters and proposals.

 **File Format:** Word saves files in the .docx format by default. This is an open format that can be read by other word processors such as Google Docs and LibreOffice Writer.

## Main Features of Microsoft Word

| Feature               | Description                                                      |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Text Formatting       | Change font, size, colour, bold, italic, underline, and more     |
| Styles                | Apply consistent formatting throughout a document with one click |
| Tables                | Create structured grids for data, schedules, and comparisons     |
| Images & Shapes       | Insert pictures, icons, SmartArt, and drawn shapes               |
| Track Changes         | Collaborate by recording every edit made to a document           |
| Mail Merge            | Generate personalised letters or labels from a data list         |
| Table of Contents     | Automatically generate a linked table of contents                |
| Spell & Grammar Check | Built-in proofreading with suggestions for corrections           |

## Common Tasks in Microsoft Word

### Creating and Saving a Document

1. Open Word and click Blank Document or choose a template
2. Start typing your content
3. Press Ctrl+S, choose a location, and enter a file name
4. Click Save — your file is saved as a .docx file

## Formatting Text

Select the text you want to format, then use the Home tab on the Ribbon:

- **Bold:** Ctrl+B — makes text heavier and more prominent
- **Italic:** Ctrl+I — adds a slant to text for emphasis
- **Underline:** Ctrl+U — draws a line beneath the text
- **Font size:** Click the number box on the Home tab and type a new size
- **Text colour:** Click the font colour button (the A with a colour bar underneath)

## Using Styles for Headings

Styles are the most powerful formatting tool in Word. Instead of manually formatting every heading, apply a built-in style:

5. Click on the paragraph you want to be a heading
6. In the Home tab, find the Styles gallery
7. Click Heading 1 for a main heading, Heading 2 for a sub-heading
8. Word will format it consistently across your document



**Pro Tip:** Using Styles also allows Word to automatically build a Table of Contents for your document. Go to References > Table of Contents to insert one.

## Inserting a Table

9. Click where you want the table
10. Go to Insert > Table
11. Drag over the grid to choose the number of rows and columns
12. Click to insert the table, then type in each cell

## Practical Examples

### Example 1: Writing a Business Letter

A business letter typically includes: your address, the date, the recipient's address, a formal greeting, the body paragraphs, a closing phrase, and your signature.

- Type your contact details at the top right
- Leave a blank line and type the date
- Type the recipient's name and address on the left
- Start with 'Dear [Name],' or 'To Whom It May Concern,'
- Write your message in clear, short paragraphs
- Close with 'Yours sincerely,' and your name

## Example 2: Creating a Simple Report

Use Heading 1 for the report title, Heading 2 for major sections such as Introduction, Findings, and Conclusion. Add a Table of Contents at the beginning using References > Table of Contents. Insert a table or chart to present data clearly.

## Tips & Keyboard Shortcuts

| Shortcut            | Action                             |
|---------------------|------------------------------------|
| Ctrl + N            | Create a new document              |
| Ctrl + O            | Open an existing document          |
| Ctrl + S            | Save the current document          |
| Ctrl + P            | Print the document                 |
| Ctrl + Z / Ctrl + Y | Undo / Redo last action            |
| Ctrl + C / Ctrl + V | Copy / Paste selected content      |
| Ctrl + X            | Cut selected content               |
| Ctrl + A            | Select all content in the document |
| Ctrl + F            | Find text in the document          |
| Ctrl + H            | Find and replace text              |
| Ctrl + B / I / U    | Bold / Italic / Underline          |
| Ctrl + E            | Centre-align selected paragraph    |
| Ctrl + L / R        | Left / Right-align paragraph       |
| Ctrl + Enter        | Insert a page break                |
| F7                  | Open Spelling & Grammar check      |

# Part 3: Microsoft Excel

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## Introduction to Microsoft Excel

Microsoft Excel is the world's leading spreadsheet application. It lets you organise, calculate, and visualise data. Excel is used for budgeting, financial analysis, data management, scheduling, and much more. Even a basic knowledge of Excel is a highly valued skill in almost every industry.

 **Key Concept:** An Excel file is called a Workbook. A workbook is made up of individual Worksheets (also called sheets or tabs). Each worksheet is a grid of rows and columns.

## Understanding the Excel Grid

| Term           | Definition                                         | Example      |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Cell           | The individual box where data is entered           | A1, B3, C10  |
| Row            | A horizontal line of cells, numbered 1, 2, 3...    | Row 5        |
| Column         | A vertical line of cells, labelled A, B, C...      | Column D     |
| Cell Reference | The address of a cell (column letter + row number) | B2           |
| Range          | A group of cells selected together                 | A1:D10       |
| Formula        | A calculation starting with an = sign              | =A1+B1       |
| Function       | A built-in formula for common calculations         | =SUM(A1:A10) |

## Main Features of Microsoft Excel

- Formulas & Functions — Perform calculations from simple sums to complex statistical analysis
- Charts & Graphs — Visualise data with bar, line, pie, and many other chart types
- Sorting & Filtering — Organise and find data quickly in large tables
- Conditional Formatting — Automatically colour cells based on their values
- PivotTables — Summarise and analyse large datasets with drag-and-drop ease
- Data Validation — Control what data can be entered into a cell

- VLOOKUP / XLOOKUP — Search for values across tables

## Common Tasks in Microsoft Excel

### Entering and Formatting Data

13. Click on a cell and start typing — press Enter to move down, Tab to move right
14. To format a number as currency: select the cells, press Ctrl+1, choose Currency
15. To format as a date: press Ctrl+1, choose Date, and select a format
16. To make text bold, select the cells and press Ctrl+B

### Writing Your First Formula

All formulas begin with an equals sign (=). Click on a cell and type:

- =A1+B1 — adds the values in cells A1 and B1
- =A1-B1 — subtracts B1 from A1
- =A1\*B1 — multiplies A1 and B1
- =A1/B1 — divides A1 by B1

 **Tip:** You can click on cells while typing a formula instead of typing the cell reference manually. Excel will insert the correct reference for you automatically.

### Essential Excel Functions

| Function        | What It Does                                  | Example                     |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| =SUM()          | Adds a range of numbers                       | =SUM(B2:B10)                |
| =AVERAGE()      | Calculates the mean of a range                | =AVERAGE(C2:C20)            |
| =COUNT()        | Counts cells containing numbers               | =COUNT(A1:A50)              |
| =MAX() / =MIN() | Returns the largest / smallest value          | =MAX(D2:D100)               |
| =IF()           | Returns different values based on a condition | =IF(A1>10,"Pass","Fail")    |
| =VLOOKUP()      | Looks up a value in a table                   | =VLOOKUP(A2,Sheet2!A:C,2,0) |
| =CONCATENATE()  | Joins text from multiple cells                | =CONCATENATE(A2," ",B2)     |
| =TODAY()        | Returns today's date                          | =TODAY()                    |
| =COUNTIF()      | Counts cells meeting a condition              | =COUNTIF(A1:A20,">100")     |
| =ROUND()        | Rounds a number to specified digits           | =ROUND(A1,2)                |



## Practical Examples

### Example 1: Monthly Budget Tracker

Column A: Expense category (Rent, Food, Transport...). Column B: Budgeted amount. Column C: Actual amount spent. Column D: formula =B2-C2 to show the difference. Use =SUM(C2:C20) at the bottom to see total spending.

### Example 2: Sales Performance Table

Column A: Salesperson name. Column B: Target. Column C: Actual sales. Column D: =C2/B2\*100 to show percentage achieved. Apply Conditional Formatting to Column D — colour cells red if below 80% and green if above 100%.

## Tips & Keyboard Shortcuts

| Shortcut          | Action                                       |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Ctrl + N          | New workbook                                 |
| Ctrl + S          | Save workbook                                |
| Ctrl + Z / Y      | Undo / Redo                                  |
| Ctrl + C / V / X  | Copy / Paste / Cut                           |
| Ctrl + Home       | Go to cell A1                                |
| Ctrl + End        | Go to last used cell                         |
| Ctrl + Arrow keys | Jump to the edge of a data range             |
| Ctrl + Shift + L  | Toggle AutoFilter on/off                     |
| Ctrl + T          | Convert range to a formatted Table           |
| F2                | Edit the currently selected cell             |
| Alt + =           | Auto-sum selected cells                      |
| Ctrl + 1          | Open Format Cells dialogue                   |
| Ctrl + ;          | Insert today's date                          |
| Ctrl + D          | Copy the cell above down into selected cells |
| Escape            | Cancel an entry or formula                   |

# Part 4: Microsoft PowerPoint

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## Introduction to Microsoft PowerPoint

Microsoft PowerPoint is the leading presentation software in the world. It lets you create slides that combine text, images, charts, and animations to communicate your message visually. PowerPoint is used for business pitches, school projects, training sessions, conference talks, and everything in between.

 **Key Concept:** A PowerPoint file is called a Presentation and is saved with the .pptx extension. A presentation is made up of individual Slides arranged in sequence.

## Understanding the PowerPoint Interface

| Area                    | Description                                                        |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Slide Panel (left)      | Shows a thumbnail of each slide — click to navigate between slides |
| Slide Canvas (centre)   | The main editing area where you design your slide                  |
| Notes Panel (bottom)    | Add speaker notes visible only to you during presentation          |
| Ribbon (top)            | All formatting and design tools organised in tabs                  |
| View Bar (bottom right) | Switch between Normal, Slide Sorter, and Presenter views           |

## Main Features of Microsoft PowerPoint

- Slide Layouts — Pre-designed arrangements for title, content, comparison, and blank slides
- Themes & Design — Apply a consistent colour scheme and font set across all slides
- Transitions — Animated effects that play between slides during a presentation
- Animations — Animate individual elements such as text or images on a slide
- Slide Master — Edit one master slide to apply changes to all slides at once
- SmartArt — Create professional diagrams, org charts, and process flows easily
- Presenter View — See your notes and upcoming slides while the audience sees only the current slide
- Record Slide Show — Record narration and timings for self-running presentations

## Common Tasks in Microsoft PowerPoint

### Creating a New Presentation

17. Open PowerPoint and click New Presentation or choose a Theme
18. The first slide will have a Title layout — click to add your title and subtitle
19. To add a new slide: press Ctrl+M or right-click in the Slides panel and choose New Slide
20. Choose a layout from the Layout menu on the Home tab

### Working with Text Boxes

Click on any text placeholder on a slide to start typing. To add a new text box anywhere on the slide, go to Insert > Text Box, draw a box with your mouse, and type.

### Inserting Images and Charts

- Images: Go to Insert > Pictures, choose a file from your computer or search Online Pictures
- Charts: Go to Insert > Chart, select a chart type, then edit the data in the mini-spreadsheet that appears
- Icons: Go to Insert > Icons for professional, scalable graphics from Microsoft's library

### Applying Transitions and Animations

- Transitions: Click on a slide in the panel, go to the Transitions tab, and click an effect
- Animations: Select an element on the slide, go to the Animations tab, and choose an effect
- Use the Animation Pane to control the order and timing of animations

### Running Your Presentation

21. Press F5 to start from the beginning, or Shift+F5 to start from the current slide
22. Use arrow keys or click to advance slides
23. Press B to black out the screen, W for white — useful during pauses
24. Press Escape to end the presentation

## Design Best Practices

 **Design Rule:** A great presentation supports the speaker — it does not replace them. Use slides for visuals and key points, not for reading entire paragraphs aloud.

| Principle      | Recommendation                                                |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Text per slide | No more than 6 bullet points; no more than 6 words per bullet |

| Principle       | Recommendation                                                  |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Font size       | Minimum 24pt for body text; 36pt or larger for titles           |
| Colour contrast | Always use dark text on a light background (or vice versa)      |
| Images          | Use high-resolution images; avoid blurry or pixelated photos    |
| Animations      | Use sparingly — one subtle entrance animation is enough         |
| Consistency     | Use the same font, colours, and layout style throughout         |
| White space     | Leave breathing room; do not crowd slides with too much content |

## Practical Examples

### Example 1: A Project Update Slide Deck

Slide 1: Title slide with project name and date. Slide 2: Agenda. Slides 3–5: Status of each workstream with traffic-light colour coding (red/amber/green). Slide 6: Key risks and issues. Slide 7: Next steps and owners. Slide 8: Q&A / Thank you.

### Example 2: A Training Presentation

Use a consistent theme throughout. Start with a Learning Objectives slide. Break content into short sections of 3–5 slides each. Include a quiz or check-your-understanding activity partway through. End with a summary and reference slide.

## Tips & Keyboard Shortcuts

| Shortcut         | Action                                   |
|------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Ctrl + N         | New presentation                         |
| Ctrl + M         | Insert a new slide                       |
| Ctrl + D         | Duplicate the selected slide             |
| Ctrl + Shift + M | Insert blank slide                       |
| F5               | Start slide show from beginning          |
| Shift + F5       | Start from current slide                 |
| Escape           | End slide show                           |
| B / W            | Black / White screen during presentation |

| Shortcut            | Action                                   |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Ctrl + Z / Y        | Undo / Redo                              |
| Ctrl + G            | Group selected objects                   |
| Ctrl + Shift + G    | Ungroup objects                          |
| Ctrl + [ / ]        | Decrease / Increase font size            |
| Ctrl + E            | Centre-align text or object              |
| Alt + Shift + Arrow | Move selected object by small increments |
| Tab                 | Cycle through objects on a slide         |

 **Final Advice:** Consistent daily practice is the fastest way to learn. Even 20 minutes per day will build strong skills over a few months. Use real tasks — your own budget, your own report — to make learning meaningful.